aroused misgivings about the soundness of the bank and it was obvious that a run was imminent. Categorical denials could not prevent the contagion from spreading to Ahmedabad. To make matters worse, some disgruntled customers who had been refused advances against unacceptable securities, joined in the attack on the bank. In the run that followed the Central Bank paid out ₹1.5 crores in six hours and ₹50 lakhs on the next day. The Calcutta and Ahmedabad branches paid ₹8 lakhs and ₹15 lakhs respectively before the run finally stopped. The Central Bank had by now suffered the greatest number of major runs and had emerged triumphant on every occasion. The failure of the Currimbhoy Mills caused another run and the bank paid out ₹3 crores in two days. This too the Central Bank took in its stride without breaking step.

While reporting on the run in August 1925, *The Times of India* wrote: 'This is not the first occasion on which baseless and possibly malicious rumours have led to a panic among the depositors of the Central Bank of India. Such panics and the consequent run on the Bank's resources which they produce are deplorable to the last degree.'[20]

Writing in a similar vein, *The Statesman* of Calcutta reported: 'It is a peculiar circumstance that these panics have centred around a bank that is exclusively Indian in its directorate and is the one purely Indian bank that is national in its operations. It should be possible to trace the originators of the rumours against the bank and to bring them to some kind of justice.'[21] The *Indian Daily Mail* noted that the 'intrepidity and presence of mind with which the authorities of the Central Bank of India met the sudden rush upon the Bank on Tuesday has produced an excellent impression on the public mind.'[22] *The Englishman* (of Calcutta) called them deliberate attacks, saying that it was always the Central Bank that was the target. 'It is significant that it is always the same bank which is attacked—the one big Indian bank and not the European banks with their strong overseas affiliations.'[23]

As Nanporia observes, 'In sum, the Bank apart, Sorabji himself emerged from these stresses with a stature that was nationwide, and it was not long before his services and advice were sought in a national context.'[24] He had proved the dictum that it is not good laws but good bankers that produce sound banking.